

From: [Katrina Glynn](#)
Sent: Wednesday, February 25, 2026 11:19:00 AM
To: [Higgins, Michelle \(DEC\)](#)
Subject: RE: DEC Adirondack and Catskill Park Smart Growth Grant Program Round 8 - C03399GM
Sensitivity: Normal
Attachments: [EEO Staffing Plan.pdf](#); [Employment Policy Statement.pdf](#);

Michelle,

Attached please find the EEO Staffing Plan and Policy Statement.

Thanks,
Katrina

From: Higgins, Michelle (DEC) <Michelle.Higgins@dec.ny.gov>
Sent: Friday, February 20, 2026 3:08 PM
To: Higgins, Michelle (DEC) <Michelle.Higgins@dec.ny.gov>
Cc: Trunko, Jillian M (DEC) <Jillian.Trunko@dec.ny.gov>; Burnham, McCrea (DEC) <McCrea.Burnham@dec.ny.gov>
Subject: DEC Adirondack and Catskill Park Smart Growth Grant Program Round 8

This message's attachments contains at least one web link. This is often used for phishing attempts. Please only interact with this attachment if you know its source and that the content is safe. If in doubt, confirm the legitimacy with the sender by phone.

Good afternoon ADK and CAT Community Smart Growth Round 8 Grantees,

This is a follow up email to the pre award notification of last week. We have not officially announced the award so please remain out of communication with media and community!

1. If you have **not** been in contact with us yet, **please let me know who will be the contact/s for this grant** - their name, title, email and phone number please so we can get our records in order.
2. Please read the long email below with all the directions first one is to send **insurance and the MWBE forms**. Most of you who are contracting out will just send workers comp and disability insurance requirements are attached. Send these to me please.
3. **MWBE send the EEO Staffing Plan and Policy Statement forms back to me (see attached)**. For the EEO, just include those in the organization currently working on the project. If that is just you then it will be for one person. Dont include people yet to be hired.
4. **MWBE 2** Utilization Plan see the User Manual attached, pages 2-5. Go to NYS Contracts (<https://ny.newnycontracts.com/>) , log in and fill in the UP as best you can from existing estimates or fill out the waiver section. Click Submit and it will be looked at by our MWBE people as we route the contract. If you have specific questions, suggest email MWBE@dec.ny.gov and include your SFS GM Supplier id or contract # (let me know if you need this) and include Smart Growth in the subject line. You can cc me as well.
5. **SDVOB** Complete the SDVOB Utilization Plan attached and send to MWBE@DEC.ny.gov. There is no website for SDVOB and the MWBE people will process the SDVOB forms.
6. If you did not receive the email below but are receiving this email you may not have the **grant award letter**. Email

me and we will resend.

7. **Next Steps** once the forms are completed we will have a call to discuss the project. We expect to have the Contract Term of April 1, 2026 March 31, 2029 approved at which time grantees can begin work at their own risk and we can begin payments (if needed) after the contract is executed, probably by the end of April if all goes well.

Let me know if you have questions.

Thanks,

Michelle

Michelle Higgins

Environmental Program Specialist 1

Department of Environmental Conservation

Division of Lands and Forests

625 Broadway, 5th Floor, Albany NY 12233

w: 518.402.8460 | michelle.higgins@dec.ny.gov

From: Higgins, Michelle (DEC)

Sent: Friday, February 13, 2026 12:34 PM

To: supervisor@indianlakeadk.com

Cc: Christine Pouch (development@indianlakeadk.com) <development@indianlakeadk.com>; Trunko, Jillian M (DEC) <jillian.trunko@dec.ny.gov>

Subject: AWARD: DEC Adirondack and Catskill Park Smart Growth Grant Program Round 8 - Town of Indian Lake

Dear,

Congratulations! This email is to inform you that your organization has been awarded an **Adirondack Park and Catskill Park Community Smart Growth Grant Round 8 2025**.

Note: The results of Adirondack and Catskill Community Smart Growth Grant Program will not be publicly announced by DEC for a few more weeks. Please take this email as advance notice of results. **We urge awardees to delay any announcements or outreach to media and community in the meantime, as DEC Commissioner Amanda Lefton will be holding a press event in the Adirondack region for these awards. We will send the official press release once it comes to hand.

We want to make sure grantees are well set up and assisted in the beginning of the grant, and throughout this project, and to let you know that we are here to help. Please take the time to go through this email and the attached documents, and we look forward to working with you soon. Suggest make a Grant Folder for Smart Growth so you have everything in one place from the beginning.

Once the forms and insurance detailed below are sent in to michelle.higgins@dec.ny.gov we will be in contact to arrange a Webex call to go over the project and answer questions. You can invite your team members and our admin and program manager will be in attendance as well. We will go over the bid, the Project Summary, Work Plan and Budget areas.

We have 30 days for this section and 90 days total to execute the contract from the date of this email. **The Contract**

Term is March 1, 2026 February 28, 2029.

****By return, please let us know who will be working on this grant (including name, title, email and phone) and who should receive emails for contracting, progress reports and payments. Going forward, please let us know if there are staff changes.**

Next Steps:

1. **Smart Growth Website details** For general information regarding DEC's ADK and CAT Smart Growth Grant Program, visit <https://dec.ny.gov/lands/49210.html>.
2. **Contacting us at DEC in the subject line of the email**, please include the name of the organization and where possible the contract number and do this for the life of the contract. We have hundreds of contracts and do not want to make a mistake.
3. **Insurance** See attached for the insurance requirements for your project:
 1. Municipalities Workers Comp. and Disability or Exemption (CE-200); no Liability needed.
 2. Non-for-profits, SWCDs and CCEs - if contracting out the project - Workers Comp, Disability or Exemption (CE-200);
 3. Non-for-profits, SWCDs and CCEs - if salaried personnel or volunteers are performing fieldwork, training or hiring volunteers, interns, seasonal workers or employees Workers Comp, Disability or Exemption (CE-200) plus Liability (ACORD, 30-Day Cancellation, Waiver of Subrogation and Additional Insured please work with your insurance carrier on this and provide them with the attached insurance requirements 90% of awardees get this wrong if they don't send the attached requirements.

Please send in one email to michelle.higgins@dec.ny.gov.

4. **MWBE and SDVOB** - See attached in this email Policy Statement to sign and Equal Opportunity Staffing Plan to be completed for staff and known contractors already on board for this project.

MWBE Utilization Plan - An MWBE Utilization Plan is required to be submitted prior to contract execution. To submit an MWBE Utilization Plan, log in to [NYS CS](https://nyscs.dec.ny.gov). For further guidance, refer to the attached Utilization Plan manual. Contact MWBE@dec.ny.gov if the plan is not visible on the dashboard.

Please remember: There is a 30% goal on all ADK and CAT Community Smart Growth Grant Program grant contract awards unless otherwise determined. It is crucial to emphasize that adherence to NYS Executive Law Article 15-A mandates MWBE compliance through the demonstration of thorough Good Faith Efforts (GFE). Simply advertising in the NYS Contractor Reporter will not suffice. Grantees and contractors must actively engage and solicit MWBEs and SDVOBs for subcontracting opportunities within the grant contract budget to ensure compliance. Please feel free to use the Good Faith Efforts Guide and MWBE Solicitation Log to track GFE.

For assistance in ensuring compliance with GFE or creating an MWBE vendor list for solicitation, please contact MWBE@dec.ny.gov. This is highly recommended.

Service-Disabled Veteran-Owned Businesses (SDVOB) - NYSDEC - Contractors with a SDVOB subcontracting goal established within their contract must make good-faith efforts to subcontract SDVOBs for the percentage of the contract outlined in the SDVOB section of the contract. Contractors must complete and upload the [SDVOB-100 Utilization Plan](#) in SFS prior to the contract execution, even if a contractor has not been chosen yet.

[SDVOB-101 Quarterly Compliance forms](#) will be submitted to sdvob@dec.ny.gov on the 10th of the month following each quarter.

Please remember: There is a 6% goal on all ADK and CAT Smart Growth Grant Program grant contract awards unless otherwise determined. It is crucial to emphasize that adherence to NYS Veteran Services Law, Article 3 mandates SDVOB compliance through the demonstration of thorough Good Faith Efforts (GFE). Simply advertising in the NYS Contractor Reporter will not suffice. Grantees and contractors must actively engage and solicit MWBEs and SDVOBs for subcontracting opportunities within the grant contract budget to ensure compliance. Please reach out to SDVOB@DEC.NY.GOV with any questions.

Good Faith Effort Guide See attached, the Good Faith Effort is used after bidding is completed or if a waiver will be

requested. Use the Solicitation log or an MWBE Directory list to show details of MWBE vendors and contractors solicited for your project and the results. This should be sent to mwbe@dec.ny.gov for review.

5.Pre-Contract work Please take time to read the Guidelines for All Awardees. At this time, most awardees will meet with their staff and other partners and map out the project responsibilities, including Outreach & Education where applicable. Any work that does not incur costs against the funding can be done, including compiling bidding documents or quotes.

6.Bidding MWBE and SDVOB for this grant round will include bidding for contractors. While the DEC will work with grantees as per their local procurement policy, we expect that everyone will either issue formal bids or request three estimates depending on the project.

7.SFS Grants Management - The contract for this award will be completed and signed in Grants Management and the Progress Reports will also be submitted to Grants Management and we will host a webinar in June 2026 for grantees to go through the progress report portal in SFS GM. Roles and ids/passwords in SFS/Grants Management should be accessed and available for the people that will work on this contract. Claim Form packages for project reimbursement will be sent to me, although we will be moving to SFS GM for voucher/ Claim Form payments at some point during 2026. The current Claim Form is attached in this email.

8. Roles for Grantees in SFS GM - Everyone has a Primary Contact in SFS GM and that person can give out roles to others in order for them to submit Progress Reports. See the basics of how to set roles for people in your organization at this link [SFS Handbook: Grantee Processing in SFS](#) page 13 of the document [Maintaining Grantee Information](#). We suggest you check into your primary contact information without delay and definitely within the next 30 days **let me know if you need help**. Everyone should have all the roles except Contract Approver and reserve that for the appropriate person/s. Once you have roles you will be able to access all areas of SFS and work on the contract. Work on the contract cannot begin until it is routed to you after insurance, MWBE forms are received and the contract call is completed. You will need people to have roles for Claim Forms later in 2026, submitting progress reports and contract approval as well as grant initiation and submission.

9.Contract Work can begin at your own risk as of the Contract Start Date, which is anticipated to be **2/1/2026** for everyone. Payments can be begin and costs can be incurred once the Master Contract for Grants (MCG) is executed, anticipated by **4/1/2026**. After the contract Work Plan is approved by DEC and grantee (you), it will be sent on for agency signatures. The Awardees Contract Approver in SFS Grants Management will receive an email when the grantee needs to go on and sign electronically. This should be the top elected official or department head, and the CEO equivalent in non-for-profits. We have 90 days total to build the contract and fulfill this contract requirement, starting with today's date.

10.Payments/Claim Forms see attached. Please send reimbursement Payment Request Packages to michelle.higgins@dec.ny.gov. DEC does not yet have the ability to submit Claim Forms through SFS/Grants Management but we will during 2026. Once a Claim Form is approved, it is processed in our office within a few days and then the State will send reimbursement electronically within 30 days. See page 1 of the Claim Form Package attached for directions for signing up with E-Pay.

11.EPF attribution attached is the EPF attribution for the EPF funding of this grant along with a DEC logo. The funding attribution should be used in all education and outreach and wherever the grant is discussed such as press releases and social media but would also include kiosk artwork, Comp Plans, signage of all sorts etc.

12.DEC ADK and CAT Community Smart Growth Press Release - please utilize the attached press release to announce your grant award locally and on your websites/social media. Where possible, forward any press to us!

13. Non-for-profits please check your pre-qualification status and make sure current forms are available. The forms most commonly missed are the ones for Charities Registration and tax forms.

Thank you for your prompt attention to developing this contract and congratulations again. Let us know if you have questions there is a lot to take in at once!

Kind regards,

Michelle

Michelle Higgins

Environmental Program Specialist 1

Department of Environmental Conservation

Division of Lands and Forests

625 Broadway, 5th Floor, Albany NY 12233

w: 518.402.8460 | michelle.higgins@dec.ny.gov

EEO Staffing Plan.pdf

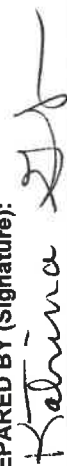
STAFFING PLAN

Please see instructions on page 2.

Contract Number: C03399GM	Reporting Entity: Municipality	Report includes Contractor's/Subcontractor's: ☒ Workforce to be utilized on this contract ☐ Total workforce
Contractor's Name: Village of Saranac Lake Contractor's Address: 39 Main Street, Suite 9 Saranac Lake, NY 12983		
Offeror ☐ Subcontractor ☐ Subcontractor's name _____		

Enter the total number of employees for each classification in each of the EEO-Job Categories identified

EEO-Job Category	Total Workforce	Workforce by Gender			Workforce by Race/Ethnic Identification														
		Total	Total	Total	White		Black		Hispanic		Asian		Native American		Disabled		Veteran		
		Male (M)	Female (F)	X (X)	(M)	(F)	(X)	(M)	(F)	(X)	(M)	(F)	(X)	(M)	(F)	(X)	(M)	(F)	(X)
Officials/Administrators	2	2			2														
Professionals	4		4			4													
Technicians																			
Sales Workers																			
Office/Clerical	3		3			3													
Craft Workers																			
Laborers																			
Service Workers																			
Temporary /Apprentices																			
Totals	9	2	7																

PREPARED BY (Signature): 	TELEPHONE NO.: EMAIL ADDRESS: comdev@saranackaleny.gov 518-891-4150 x 235	DATE: 02/25/2026
NAME AND TITLE OF PREPARER (Print or Type): Katrina Glynn		Submit completed with bid or proposal MWBE 101 (Rev 01/2023)

General instructions: All Offerors and each subcontractor identified in the bid or proposal must complete an EEO Staffing Plan (MWBE 101) and submit it as part of the bid or proposal package. Where the workforce to be utilized in the performance of the State contract can be separated out from the contractor's and/or subcontractor's total workforce, the Offeror shall complete this form only for the anticipated workforce to be utilized on the State contract. Where the workforce to be utilized in the performance of the State contract cannot be separated out from the contractor's and/or subcontractor's total workforce, the Offeror shall complete this form for the contractor's and/or subcontractor's total workforce.

Instructions for completing:

1. Enter the Solicitation number that this report applies to along with the name and address of the Offeror.
2. Check off the appropriate box to indicate if the Offeror completing the report is the contractor or a subcontractor.
3. Check off the appropriate box to indicate workforce to be utilized on the contract or the Offerors' total workforce.
4. Enter the total workforce by EEO job category.
5. Break down the anticipated total workforce by gender and enter under the heading 'Workforce by Gender'
6. Break down the anticipated total workforce by race/ethnic identification and enter under the heading 'Workforce by Race/Ethnic Identification'. Contact the OMWBE Permissible contact(s) for the solicitation if you have any questions.
7. Enter information on disabled or veterans included in the anticipated workforce under the appropriate headings.
8. Enter the name, title, phone number and email address for the person completing the form. Sign and date the form in the designated boxes.

RACE/ETHNIC IDENTIFICATION

Race/ethnic designations as used by the Equal Employment Opportunity Commission do not denote scientific definitions of anthropological origins. For the purposes of this form, an employee may be included in the group to which he or she appears to belong, identifies with, or is regarded in the community as belonging. However, no person should be counted in more than one race/ethnic group. The race/ethnic categories for this survey are:

- **WHITE:** (Not of Hispanic origin) All persons having origins in any of the original peoples of Europe, North Africa, or the Middle East.
- **BLACK:** a person, not of Hispanic origin, who has origins in any of the black racial groups of the original peoples of Africa.
- **HISPANIC:** a person of Mexican, Puerto Rican, Cuban, Central or South American or other Spanish culture or origin, regardless of race.
- **ASIAN & PACIFIC:** a person having origins in any of the original peoples of the Far East, Southeast Asia, the Indian subcontinent or the Pacific Islands.
- **NATIVE INDIAN**
(NATIVE AMERICAN/ ALASKAN): a person having origins in any of the original peoples of North America, and who maintains cultural identification through tribal affiliation or community recognition.

OTHER CATEGORIES

- **DISABLED INDIVIDUAL:** any person who:
 - has a physical or mental impairment that substantially limits one or more major life activity(ies)
 - has a record of such an impairment; or
 - is regarded as having such an impairment.
- **VIETNAM ERA VETERAN:** a veteran who served at any time between and including January 1, 1963 and May 7, 1975.
- **GENDER:** Male, Female, or X

Employment Policy Statement.pdf

**NEW YORK STATE DEPARTMENT OF ENVIRONMENTAL CONSERVATION (DEC)
MWBE & SDVOB EQUAL EMPLOYMENT OPPORTUNITY POLICY STATEMENT**

I (Authorized Representative), Bachana Tsiklauri, agree to adopt the following policies with
respect to contract # C03399GM for Village of Saranac Lake (Vendor/Awardee).

NON-DISCRIMINATION & EQUAL EMPLOYMENT OPPORTUNITY POLICY

- a) This organization will not discriminate against any employee or applicant for employment because of race, creed, color, national origin, gender, age, disability or marital status, will undertake or continue existing programs of affirmative action to ensure that minority group members are afforded equal employment opportunities without discrimination, and shall make and document its conscientious and active efforts to employ and utilize minority group members and women in its workforce on state contracts.
- b) This organization shall state in all solicitations or advertisements for employees, that under the performance of this contract all qualified applicants will be afforded equal employment opportunities without discrimination because of race, creed, color, national origin, gender, age, sex disability, or marital status.
- c) At the request of the Empire State Development (ESD), this organization shall require each employment agency, labor union, or authorized representative not discriminate on the basis of race, creed, color, national origin, gender, age, disability, or marital status and that such union or representative will affirmatively cooperate in the implementation of this organization's obligations herein.
- d) The organization shall comply with the provisions of the Human Rights Law, all other State and Federal statutory and constitutional non-discrimination provisions. The organization and its sub-vendors shall not discriminate against any employee or applicant for employment because of race, creed (religion), color, gender, national origin, sexual orientation, military status, age, disability, predisposing genetic characteristic, marital status, or domestic violence victim status, and shall also follow the requirements of the Human Rights Law regarding non-discrimination based on prior criminal conviction and prior arrest.
- e) The organization will include the provisions of sections (a) through (d) of this agreement in every subcontract in such a manner that the requirements of subdivisions will be binding upon each subcontractor as to work in connection with the State contract.

MWBE AND SDVOB POLICY STATEMENT

MWBE

This organization will and will cause its contractors and subcontractors to make good faith efforts to achieve the MWBE contract participation goals set by the state for that area in which the state-funded project is located, by taking the following steps:

1. Actively and affirmatively solicit bids for contracts and subcontracts from qualified state certified MBEs or WBEs, including solicitations to MWBE contractor associations.
2. Request a list of state certified MWBEs from the DEC and solicit bids from them directly.
3. Ensure that plans, specifications, request for proposals, and other documents used to secure bids will be made available in sufficient time for review by prospective MWBEs.
4. Where feasible, divide the work into smaller portions to enhanced participation by MWBEs.
5. Document and maintain records of bid solicitations, including those to MWBEs and the results thereof. Contractor will also maintain records of actions that its subcontractors have taken toward meeting MWBE contract participation goals.
6. Ensure that payments to MWBEs are made on a timely basis so that undue financial hardship is avoided.

SDVOB

This organization will and will cause its contractors and subcontractors to make good faith efforts to achieve the SDVOB contract participation goals set by the state for that area in which the State-funded project is located, by taking the following steps:

1. Actively and affirmatively solicit bids for contracts and subcontracts from qualified state certified SDVOBs, including solicitations to contractor associations.
2. Request a list of State-certified SDVOBs from the DEC and solicit bids from them directly
3. Ensure that plans, specifications, request for proposals and other documents used to secure bids will be made available in sufficient time for review by prospective SDVOBs.
4. Where feasible, divide the work into smaller portions to enhanced participations by SDVOBs.
5. Document and maintain records of bid solicitations, including those to SDVOBs and the results thereof. Contractor will also maintain records of actions that its subcontractors have taken toward meeting SDVOB contract participation goals.
6. Ensure that progress payments to SDVOBs are made on a timely basis so that undue financial hardship is avoided.

Authorized Representative Signature:



Title: Village Manager

Date: 02/25/2026